

No Easy Answer...

Instructions

Read your case carefully. Discuss the arguments on both sides before reaching a decision.

Consider:

- What are the strongest arguments on each side?
- Is there any information you would like to know?
- What is the fairest outcome?
- Can you defend your decision?

Case 1 – The Secret Recording

Maya suspects that her boyfriend is cheating on her. After noticing several suspicious messages, she secretly leaves a recording device in their shared apartment while she is away for the weekend.

The recording confirms that he has indeed been having an affair.

When confronted, he admits everything but argues that secretly recording private conversations was itself a serious betrayal.

Maya's friends are very divided by her action.

Your decision: Was Maya justified in secretly recording him?

Case 2 – The Influencer's Secret

A fitness influencer with five million followers has built a successful career promoting a particular diet and exercise programme. They regularly post before-and-after photographs and tell followers that their lifestyle explains their dramatic weight loss.

A journalist discovers that the influencer has also been using prescription weight-loss medication but has never mentioned this publicly.

The influencer argues that their medical treatment is private and that the diet and exercise advice they give is still useful. Critics argue that millions of followers are being given a misleading impression of what the programme can achieve.

Your decision: Should the influencer be expected to reveal their use of medication?

Case 3 – The Billionaire's Donation

A billionaire offers a university **£100 million** to build a new research centre. The money could fund hundreds of scholarships and potentially important medical research.

However, the billionaire made much of their fortune through a company accused of exploiting workers and causing serious environmental damage.

The university argues that accepting the money does not mean endorsing the donor. Student campaigners argue that the university would be allowing the billionaire to improve their reputation using money made through unethical practices.

Your decision: Should the university accept the donation?

Case 4 – The Racist Tweet

A company discovers that one of its employees posted a racist joke on social media when they were **16 years old**.

They are now 27. There is no evidence that they currently hold racist views, and colleagues from different backgrounds strongly defend them. The employee apologises and says they are ashamed of what they wrote as a teenager.

However, the old post has gone viral and thousands of people online are demanding that the company dismiss them.

Your decision: Should the employee lose their job?

Case 5 – The Protest

A group of climate activists block a major road during rush hour. Their protest receives enormous media coverage.

However, an ambulance carrying a seriously ill patient is delayed for 20 minutes. The patient survives, but doctors say the delay could have had serious consequences.

The protesters argue that climate change threatens millions of lives and that peaceful protests which cause no disruption are easily ignored. Critics argue that protesters have no right to endanger innocent people.

Your decision: Was the protest justified?

Case 6 – The Deepfake

A university student creates a highly realistic AI-generated video showing a famous but controversial politician saying offensive (and ridiculous) things.

The video is intended as comedy and originally includes a clear label saying "AI-generated parody."

Other users download the video and repost it **without the label**. Millions of people eventually see it, and most believe it is genuine.

The student argues that the original video was clearly labelled and that they cannot be responsible for what other people subsequently do with their work.

The politician in question wants the university to expel the student who created the video, arguing it has caused them immense reputational damage.

Your decision: Should the student be held responsible for the consequences?

Case 7 – The Lottery Secret

Five friends have played the same lottery numbers together every week for three years. Each normally contributes £2.

One week, four of the friends forget to send their money. The fifth decides to buy the ticket anyway using their usual numbers.

The ticket wins **£10 million**.

The person who bought the ticket argues that they alone paid for the winning ticket, so the money belongs to them. The other four argue that they have played those numbers together for years and would obviously have shared the winnings if the situation had been reversed.

Your decision: Should the £10 million be shared between all five friends?

Case 8 – The Private Group Chat

A group of university students has a private group chat. One member makes several offensive jokes that would probably cause serious problems if they became public.

Another member takes screenshots of the messages and sends them to the university.

The university begins disciplinary proceedings. The students argue that the messages were part of a private conversation between friends and were never intended for a wider audience. Others argue that offensive behaviour does not become acceptable simply because it takes place privately.

Your decision: Should the university punish the students?